

THE SLEEPING BEAUTY

A PLAY

WITH OR WITHOUT

PAGEANTRY

BY

THEODORA DU BOIS

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a play in three acts

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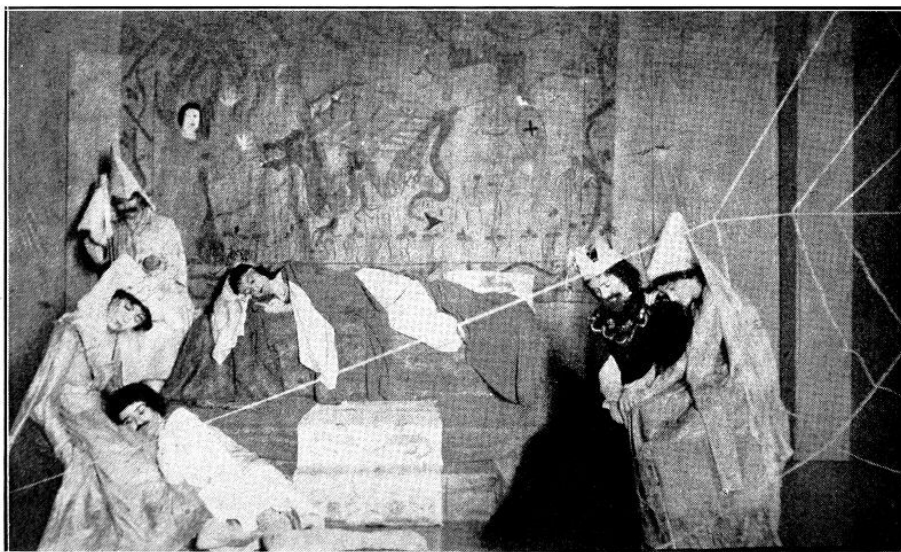
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BEAUTY ***

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THE SLEEPING PALACE

THE SLEEPING BEAUTY

A PLAY IN THREE ACTS

BY

THEODORA DU BOIS

AS PRODUCED BY THE
WORKSHOP PLAYERS OF YONKERS

*This play may be given with much PAGEANTRY,
if desired*

AMATEURS ARE GIVEN PERMISSION TO PRESENT THIS PLAY,
BUT

NO PROFESSIONAL PERFORMANCE MAY TAKE PLACE

WITHOUT CONSENT OF THE AUTHOR.

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THE SLEEPING BEAUTY^[1]

A PLAY IN THREE ACTS

BY

THEODORA DU BOIS.

ACT I.

In the Second Best Throne Room of the King and Queen.

ACT II. (*Sixteen years later.*)

Scene 1. Same as Act I.

Scene 2. In the Palace Attics.

Scene 3. Same as Act I.

ACT III. (*A hundred years later.*)

Scene 1. Outside the Dragon-proof Hedge.

Scene 2. In the Second Best Throne Room of the King and Queen.

(The First Act takes twenty-four minutes to play, the Second Act takes twenty-four minutes to play, and the Third Act takes fifteen minutes to play.)

PEOPLE OF THE PLAY.^[2]

The King.

The Queen.

The Princess.

The Prince.

Fairy of the Golden Isles.

Fairy of the Crystal Mountains.

Fairy of the Silver Rivers.

Fairy of the Sable Caves.

The Page.

The Courtier.

} Same person.

Attendant to Princess.

Gentlemen In Waiting to Prince.

ACT I.

The curtain rises, showing the Second Best Throne Room of the King and Queen. It may either be hung with softly draped curtains, or have walls, representing gray rock, hung with old tapestries behind the throne and on the side walls. There is one entrance at the right, near the rear wall. In the center rear is a dais, and upon it a divan. At the right of the dais, near the front of the stage, is a chest. Opposite, at the left, is a cradle, with a small stool near by.^[3]

The King is seated on the divan, which is the throne, half facing the right wall, working out a plan of battle with toy knights on a board. The Queen is seated on the chest, facing the audience. She is surrounded by half opened parchments, and is scribbling in a hurried, worried, manner, with a quill pen. Both she and the King are dressed for the christening, and are wearing crowns.

QUEEN (*frantically*).

ir, I'm having such an awful time!

KING (*not looking up*).

is that?

QUEEN.

is, you always say, "What's that?"

ir!

KING.

ere my knights would make a charge.

QUEEN.

ir, oh dear, oh dear, what can I do?

KING (*mildly*).

re I don't know. What's the matter dear?—
knights would steal up in the dark, and then—

QUEEN (*interrupting crossly*).

en they'd all be killed, I surely hope.

KING.

ar, but what an odd remark to make.

QUEEN (*biting her pen*).

ou'd say odd things, too, if you were me.

KING (*reprovingly*).

i were I," my dear, you should have said.
e so careless in these little things,
imagine what your school was like.

QUEEN.

I went to school, I've told you that.
old wizard taught me everything.

KING (*not much interested*).

s, arithmetic, and things like that—

QUEEN.

elementary magic! nothing dull
spelling, writing, and arithmetic.
ed to have a lesson every day:
forming things, stones into little cakes
sing,—useful things like that we learned. (*She turns back to her work.*)
ar, I simply can not get this straight!

KING.

s that you want to do my dear?

QUEEN.

pying the baby's Christening list
e the steward—so he'll know the names
the people that I've asked to come.
ow I cannot read the names myself.
e them in a hurry. I don't know
s invited now—or who is not.
ing is in a simply awful mess,
ow it's getting late, and all the guests
e there in a minute! Dear, oh dear!

KING (*Gets up and comes to her side. He takes up the parchments
and puzzles over them*).

riting is a bit like beetle tracks—

QUEEN.

ry, do, it's really awfully late.

KING (*frowning*).

ee whom you've asked first. What names are these?

QUEEN.

are my cousins, you remember them,
gave us that enchanted silver bowl
we were married.

KING.

1 yes, of course.
iiry of the Golden Isles—I see—
iiry of the Silver Rivers, and
iiry of the Crystal Mountains. Yes,
member them now, perfectly.
airies, too. How stupid to forget.
re all these?

QUEEN.

the more common guests
I just come in for tea this afternoon,
our ceremonies all are through.

KING.

Cinderella and the Prince, I see.
Hard? (*very angrily.*) I don't see why you asked that man!

QUEEN.

He is my *best* friend.

KING (*with meaning*).

She won't be, long.
Is this? Aladdin?

QUEEN.

He's visiting.

KING.

Well—I hope *he* comes. Perhaps he'll stay
and smoke a pipe after the rest have gone. (*reading hurriedly.*)
Hum te-hum-te-hum te-hum,
If the hum te-hum te-hum te-hum,
Hum-te-de, King tum te tum te tum,
I-te tum—King of the Pearly-gates.
Of the Pomegranate Garden-tum-te-tum—
Precious, but you've surely asked a lot.

QUEEN (*proudly*).

It's the biggest party ever held
in the kingdoms. Baby should be proud. (*She looks in the cradle.*)
All this great big party's just for her,
For her Christening. Oh the sweetum's thing.

see—the duckie!

KING.

-don't wake her up. (*He looks at the list again.*)
Is this name here that seems to be scratched out?

QUEEN.

don't know, I'm sure. What can it be?

KING.

Is like "Stable Calves"—it can't be that,
can it? That's an awfully funny name
is to me, for any fairy. Why,
"Fairy of the Stable Calves"—Oh no!
Where we don't know anyone like that.

QUEEN (*recognizing it*).

—it's "Fairy of the Sable Caves"!

KING (*amazed*).

Oh! Aunt Fairy of the Sable Caves!

QUEEN (*sitting down on the edge of the dais in horror*).

Said I've done a simply dreadful thing!
What shall I do! I wrote that name down last,
scribbled it so badly, that, well, that
I sent all my invitations off
didn't read her name, and so I thought
it was something that had been scratched out,
and so—

KING (*angrily*).

Goodkins! zounds! gadzooks!
How do you mean she wasn't asked at all?

QUEEN (*sulkily*).

language isn't necessary dear.

KING (*half apologetically but still angry*).

forgot—I'm sorry—but my sweet,—
dn't send her invitation off?
'airy of the Sable Caves left out!
s, she'll be simply raving when she hears!
nper's worse than twenty bottles bees!

QUEEN (*going toward King*).

t a social error, dear, that's all.
rfully sorry—'cause she is your aunt,
en, to tell the truth, I never did,
t could have liked her, very much.

KING.

rely has a frightful temper. Zounds!
dn't have offended her for worlds!
t your carelessness again my dear.
ay be very horrid over this.
would *only* be more careful, pet.

QUEEN (*starting to weep*).

s, I'll try. I truly will. Oh dear!

KING (*nervously walking up and down*).

ler if there's anything to do.
apologizing? It's too late.
vell. We'll simply make the best of it.

(*Queen flings herself weeping on the divan.*)

QUEEN.

Everything is just too horrible.
Never be a rabbit or a toad,
Nothing alive (*sob*) except a queen.

KING (*trying to quiet her*).

There, my dear, there, there, now stop, you must.
Wake the baby. Stop! your eyes will be
Red and puffy for the Christening.
And put your crown on straight, at once.
Put some powder on your nose. Now come—
Because you know you'll be a perfect sight.

QUEEN (*sobbing*).

None anyway, so I don't care.

KING (*frantically*).

I say. Now do be sensible.

(*Page enters, bows with formality and stands at attention.*)

PAGE (*in loud and even tones*).

Great and glorious ruler of this realm,
Majestic and beauteous queen of all the land,
We await, in thy reception hall,
To assist her from her journey.

KING.

What's the name?

PAGE (*still at attention*).

"Fairies of the Golden Isles," oh king.

(*Queen jumps to her feet.*)

QUEEN.

It's not even time to fix my hair (*she fixes it*).
I could have told me it was getting late. (*She dabs her face with a little powder puff.*)
I look better now I think, don't you?

KING (*takes a handkerchief and wipes a tear away from the side of her cheek*).

That's the last old tear—no one would know
I ever cried in all your life. That's fine!

QUEEN.

Is my crown on straight?

KING.

Yes, it's fine.
Is my collar? Is it very mussed?

QUEEN.

It's a bit. (*She looks in cradle.*) The baby's still asleep.
How sweet! (*She sits down primly on the divan.*)
We're ready now.

KING (*taking up the parchment list of names from the chest*).

He goes unto the steward, boy. But first
I'll see the Fairy of the Golden Isles.

(*The Page bows and backs out. The King straightens the room up a little.*)

KING.

Now I hope the banquet is all right.

QUEEN.

Nothing came except the pomegranates,
No rainbow fish instead of golden carp! (*Annoyed.*)

KING.

ve can do without them, I suppose.

QUEEN.

those young spring peacocks won't be tough,
at the Roc's egg omelette isn't flat.

KING (*Sits beside Queen on divan. In doing so he rests his hand
behind her, and then suddenly leaps to his feet.*)

—Ouch! (*putting finger in mouth.*)

QUEEN (*anxious*).

ir, whatever have you done?

KING (*mumbling*).

icked it like the very mischief, dear.

QUEEN.

d it—what on?

KING (*crossly*).

nothing sharp, of course.

QUEEN.

1 so sorry! Let me see it, do.

KING.

eding! Ouch!

QUEEN (*tearing her handkerchief*).

lo it up with this. (*She winds it around his finger.*)
ler if that page has hidden tacks
h our cushions.

KING (*fiercely*).

as—I'll just—

(*Page enters and bows low. The King sits down suddenly.*)

PAGE.

at and gracious king of all this realm.

KING (*interrupting in a dreadfully fierce voice*).

at—come here—no, nearer, on your knees. (*The Page obeys, terrified.*)

e the truth now sirrah—did you put
underneath these cushions? If you did
id you to my deepest dungeon dark
h the castle moat, and for a month,
ou on bread and water. Now, the truth!

PAGE (*terrified*).

great ruler; no, I never did.

KING.

ell me what it was that pricked my hand.

PAGE (*picking up from the divan beside the King, one of the lead
knights he had been manouvering at the beginning of the
play*).

p, oh king, you pricked your hand on this. (*He holds up the little knight, and
the King touches its spear gingerly.*)

KING.

; that's it. They're spilled all over here.
ear is awfully sharp. Here, hide them quick.
at one up before the guests arrive. (*He sweeps knights into his hand and
gives them to the Page.*)

QUEEN.

ck them underneath the throne.

(Page obeys.)

KING.

right.

was it now, you were about to say.

PAGE *(rising, but trembling)*.

d and gracious ruler of this land,
ice fair beauteous and lovely queen,
airy of the Golden Isles is now
aching, up the gold and marble stairs.

KING.

ll receive our cousin, with all joy.

PAGE *(backs out)*.

h king, benign and bounteous.

KING *(to Queen)*.

hope the baby stays asleep.
apt to yell so awfully when she wakes.

PAGE *(standing at the door)*.

airy of the Golden Isles is come.

(The Fairy of the Golden Isles enters, beautifully dressed, carrying a golden ball on a cushion.)

(She kneels before the King and Queen who kiss her solemnly on the forehead.)

KING.

I come cousin, on this Christening day,
I come for our daughter and ourselves.

QUEEN.

I come cousin of the Golden Isles.
arts dance like the golden blooms of spring
you here.

FAIRY OF THE GOLDEN ISLES.

ine rejoices, too.
and is glad, like wind-kissed daisy fields.
and is glad on this glad Christening day.

QUEEN (*changing to an informal manner*).

on't you want to see our baby?
Why!
ell you're looking! What a lovely dress!

(*They all rise and look into the cradle, speaking rather low.*)

FAIRY OF THE GOLDEN ISLES.

at a darling! Why you never said
wfully sweet she was.

QUEEN.

quite sweet.

KING (*turning his moustache proudly*).

om to like her rather well, you know.

FAIRY OF THE GOLDEN ISLES.

should think you would (*to the Queen*).
beautiful!

she looks exactly like you, dear.

QUEEN.

she looks exactly like the king—
the beard—of course. (*Tweaks his beard.*)

KING.

after me.

(*Enter Page.*)

PAGE.

at and glorious ruler of this realm,
and beauteous queen of all the land,
liant Fairy of the Golden Isles—
Fairy of the Crystal Mountains comes.

QUEEN.

ll receive her here at once.

QUEEN.

yes.

(*Page bows and backs out.*)

FAIRY OF THE GOLDEN ISLES.

ar, your baby simply is too sweet!

PAGE (*reenters*).

Fairy of the Crystal Mountains, sire.

(*Page goes out as the Fairy of the Crystal Mountains enters, beautifully dressed, carrying the crystal globe of wisdom. She kneels in front of the King and Queen. They kiss her on the forehead.*)

KING.

lcome cousin, on this Christening day.
lcome for our daughter and ourselves.

QUEEN.

of the Crystal Mountains—welcome thrice.
arts dance like the crystal mists that waft
your mountain tops, to welcome you.

FAIRY OF THE CRYSTAL MOUNTAINS.

lances too, like glad nymphs in the mists,
s and sings on this glad Christening day. (*Changing her manner, and getting up.*)
et me see the baby, I can't wait! (*All look in cradle.*)
at a darling! Isn't she too, too dear!
oks exactly like the King, I think.

FAIRY OF THE GOLDEN ISLES.

she looks exactly like the Queen.

(*Page enters.*)

PAGE.

at and glorious ruler of the realm,
r and beauteous queen of all this land,
liant Fairy of the Golden Isles,
airy of the Crystal Mountains, lo
airy of the Silver Rivers comes.

(*The Fairy of the Silver Rivers enters immediately, beautifully dressed, bearing the mirror of beauty. She kneels before the King and Queen who kiss her on the forehead.*)

KING.

lcome cousin, on this Christening day.

lcome for our daughter and ourselves.

QUEEN.

lcome—Fairy of the Silver Streams.
arts dance like glad ripples on thy waves
thee here.

FAIRY OF THE SILVER RIVERS.

lances, too, like sunlight on the waves,
s and sings, on this glad Christening day.—
have brought a gift to give thy babe.

FAIRY OF THE GOLDEN ISLES.

o have I—

FAIRY OF THE CRYSTAL MOUNTAINS.

—

FAIRY OF THE GOLDEN ISLES.

ght I'd wait
he others came, so we could dance
agic gift dance as we give our gifts.

FAIRY OF THE SILVER RIVERS.

hat's a good idea—(*looks in cradle.*)
weet she is!
know which I think she looks like more.

FAIRY OF THE GOLDEN ISLES.

other.

FAIRY OF THE CRYSTAL MOUNTAINS.

r father.

FAIRY OF THE SILVER RIVERS.

ou both.
e's the loveliest baby that I've seen.

QUEEN (*smiling*).

ad you like her. But I'd like to know
here you got your dresses. Why, my dears,
e wonderful! they're simply exquisite!

FAIRY OF THE GOLDEN ISLES.

t them for to-day—we think they're nice.

KING.

o interrupt this pleasant chat.
our other guests will be here soon.

FAIRY OF THE CRYSTAL MOUNTAINS.

e must dance our dance and give our gifts. (*Goes to cradle.*)
ave to pull it out a little way,
ch too close against the wall to dance.

(*They pull the cradle to the center of the stage and begin a slow dance about it.*)^[4]

FAIRY OF THE GOLDEN ISLES (*holds ball high in air*).

his golden glowing toy
ball of mirth and joy,
hristening gift I leave thee.
t, and no harm will grieve thee. (*She puts it in the cradle and kisses the baby.*)

FAIRY OF THE CRYSTAL MOUNTAINS (*holds up globe*).

s crystal globe, before
et I lay. Deep wisdom's lore
herein—Long-bearded sages
ought this secret of the ages. (*She puts it in the cradle and kisses the baby.*)

FAIRY OF THE SILVER RIVERS (*holds up mirror*).

irror of beauty I give to thee,
ce will greet thee happily,
irest face in all the land—

(*Enter Page, running breathlessly.*)

PAGE.

thy pardon sire, but I fear!

KING.

s the matter boy? What is all this?
lo you mean by interrupting us?

PAGE.

er guest, a dreadful, cross, cross guest!
es are flashing—oh she's coming now.

(*All listen in consternation to angry sounds without. The fairies huddle together. The Queen edges close to the King. The Page, trembling, scuttles to one side of the dais.*)

QUEEN (*terrified*).

can it be?

(*The Fairy of the Sable Caves rushes in the door like a whirlwind. All the others open their mouths with astonishment and stand staring, in a semicircle. She stands looking at them in derision.*)

FAIRY OF THE SABLE CAVES.

what's the matter? Are you all struck dumb?
e you don't remember who I am,
e perhaps you're overcome with joy
ing me. Oh close your foolish mouths. (*They close their mouths sheepishly.*)
ince I've come, what have you got to say,

or yourselves?

KING (*with difficulty*).

awfully sorry—it—

FAIRY OF THE SABLE CAVES (*disagreeably*).

is, of course, it was an oversight—
wouldn't *mean* to do it for the world"—

those old excuses all by heart.

n't change the matter—not a bit.

giving a tremendous Christening,
and I—you've simply "overlooked."

was not invited—not a word!

it! the Fairy of the Sable Caves!

these poor silly, frilly fairies here, (*She points to three Fairies who shudder
and cling together.*)

ven posts of honor. Yes, that's right.

scared, I'm glad, no one can slight *me* twice.

all be sorry, good and sorry, too.

me the baby.

QUEEN (*terrified*).

she is, in there.

FAIRY OF THE SABLE CAVES.

gly baby! looks just like you both. (*looking at the King's hand.*)

that old rag around your finger for?

KING.

ed it, badly.

FAIRY OF THE SABLE CAVES.

d it? Pricked it—humph!

QUEEN.

very sorry, it was all my fault.

FAIRY OF THE SABLE CAVES.

n't matter now whose fault it was,
ould have thought of that before.

QUEEN.

ase!

FAIRY OF THE SABLE CAVES.

I will rue the day you slighted me—(*She faces the audience, waving her arms and weaving a spell.*)
I spirits of the blackest night!
osts and goblins, ghouls and specters drear—
aiths who haunt dim starlit country roads—
is and trolls who dwell in dungeon moats—
near^[5]—come near and weave a spell with me,
near and make a Christening present drear,
stening present for this sleeping child.

KING (*starting forward*).

all not hurt my daughter! I forbid.

FAIRY OF THE SABLE CAVES.

back, or I will turn you into stone. (*She compels him to step back.*)
o the spell I lay upon this child:
teen years these silly spells shall last—(*pointing to three fairies.*)
all be happy, wise, and beautiful—
in the sunlight—sing and laugh and play—
en—and then—draw near, ye elves of doom,
near ye spirits of my cave's deep gloom,
a *distaff* sharp your child shall prick
nger, till it bleeds; and pale and sick
grow—(*beckoning*) imps from my cobweb tangled sky!
van, and ill and then your child will—

(She stands triumphant while the others cower in fear.)

KING *(interrupting)*.

h no—not *that*—have mercy—oh—I pray!

FAIRY OF THE SABLE CAVES.

bye, I hope you'll have a pleasant day.

(She laughs wildly and rushes out. The Queen flings herself sobbing upon the King. The others recover a bit.)

FAIRY OF THE SILVER RIVERS *(comes forward toward Queen)*.

rying now, there's something I can do.
wer equals mine and so I can't
y her evil charms entirely.
an make them less, less, horrible.
ie your hands. *(The three Fairies join hands over the cradle.)* Now close
your eyes and wish.
hat the words I say will all come true.
incess shall not die, she shall not die,
l asleep instead, and sleep and sleep,
for a hundred years, until at last,
ce shall break the spell by kissing her,
ie shall wake again to life and joy.

(All drop hands and the tension is relaxed.)

KING *(mopping face with handkerchief)*.

can't tell you how obliged I am,
too—too kind—I—well—I simply can't.

QUEEN.

ve no words, we feel, far, far too much.
believe in evil spells at all,
n good ones, never bad ones.
ig) But I'll never have a distaff in this house.

KING.

be on the safe side. Ho page—attend! (*The Page hurriedly comes before him.*)

him to all my people in the land,
from this time no distaff may be brought
from my castle walls, on pain of death.
Who who disobeys me—dies at once.

PAGE.

Oh sire! (*He goes out.*)

QUEEN (*frantically to King*).

I simply can't
and have the party after this.

KING.

Just, now pull yourself together, dear,
make it a success; smile, grit your teeth!

QUEEN (*to Fairies*).

Look so sad my dears, it's over now,
all forget it for the afternoon.

PAGE (*entering*).

What and glorious rulers of this realm,
wristening guests await thee, all without.

KING.

Let us go to them. Come on, my dear.

QUEEN (*goes to cradle*).

Take the princess then. Come sweetums, come,
to your Christening, sweet. Come, everyone. (*The Page lifts up the cradle,
as he does so the Queen turns to the Fairies.*)

that wicked charm, it mustn't spoil
vely Christening party, and besides,
l spells are nonsense; so my dears,
simply *never* think of it again.

*(The Page goes out bearing the cradle. The others follow in single file.
Queen, King and Fairies.)*

Curtain.

ACT II. SCENE 1. (*Same as Act I. Sixteen years later.*)

(*The curtain rises upon the same room. The only change is that now a bench is in place of the cradle. The Princess, her Attendant, and the Courtier, who is the Page of the first act, grown up, are sitting on the dais steps. The Princess is in the middle. She is trying to play a mandolin, and is doing very badly. The Courtier is much bored. He and the Attendant have a little by-play behind the Princess' back, as she plays.*)

PRINCESS.

now, that's right, I think, yes, yes, that's right.

COURTIER.

even yet—I hardly think that it's—

ATTENDANT (*gently*).

you ought to strike the strings like this.

PRINCESS (*crossly*).

a princess ought to know the way.

COURTIER.

is, Your Highness owns the crystal globe
dom, and knows *everything* on earth.

PRINCESS.

dlesticks!

COURTIER.

is for beauty—why
orning star is but a homely thing,
mon little stupid point of light, (*He snaps his fingers as if at the morning
star*)

red to you. (*The Princess bends over her mandolin, much absorbed in it, and the Courtier immediately tries to hold the hand of the Attendant.*)

PRINCESS (*meaning his flattery*).

p such foolishness.

COURTIER (*quickly removing his hand*).

is for joy, the bubbling mirth of spring,
amorous delight of golden hours,
ft, sweet, soothing scent of summer showers,
diant happiness—

PRINCESS.

at a fib—
ow yourself that I am just as cross
in be to-day. I wish I knew
was the matter with me. Oh, I wish
tomorrow. I have always longed
e that birthday come: my seventeenth!
ler if I'll feel much more grown up
row. Well, at any rate I hope
t feel quite so cross—You wish it, too,
is, poor dears—I'm sorry. (*She suddenly makes a most horrible noise on the mandolin.*)

COURTIER (*putting his hands over his ears*).

—oh please.

PRINCESS (*sternly*).

you're very rude. You ought to like
ver I may do. (*Considering*) I think perhaps
ve your head chopped off at once for that.

COURTIER (*on his knees*).

oly crave thy pardon, Highness, dear,

thee, let me keep my head awhile—
it a *little* longer. I have tried
g to get this moustache, worked so hard,
d be desolate if all that work
lone in vain. And then, consider this—
ad would not be handsome on a pole.

PRINCESS.

you're much too vain. Get up at once. (*He gets up, and the Princess attempts to play something on the mandolin. They listen attentively. She finishes and looks up for applause.*)
was I playing then? I love that piece.

COURTIER.

ath song of the Seven Kitchen Cats?

PRINCESS (*disgusted*).

, it's not. I wouldn't speak at all
y time I spoke I showed myself
fully stupid as you seem to be.

COURTIER.

not all gifted as your Highness is.

PRINCESS.

very clear. I s'pose it's not your fault
ou've been born without the slightest ear
isic. Now the name of that piece was,
ath thy turret window, love, I wait."

COURTIER.

: thy pardon, Highness, my mistake.

PRINCESS.

on let's stop—I'm awfully sick of this.

the dullest day I've ever known.
it were tomorrow.

COURTIER (*feelingly*).

I. (*The Princess looks at him sternly and he hastily continues.*)
irthday, Highness, is a festal day—
ingdom and its subjects all rejoice—
ik that you were born to fill the world
adance—

PRINCESS (*in a towering rage*).

oks! odds-bodkins! now, this is enough!

ATTENDANT (*in horror*).

ligness, oh such language!

PRINCESS.

apa
ist those words, don't interrupt me please.
mply making fun of me, I know.
stand any more of this—Ho guards!

(*Courtier and Attendant throw themselves on floor.*)

ATTENDANT.

ardon him, oh Princess—think—just think
s, amuse us—

COURTIER.

nd I might spoil
ould languish in a dungeon dark.

PRINCESS.

, get up—I'm acting like a pig!
ect pig, and you're just idiots.

re I hope the day will end without
ing something simply horrible.

COURTIER (*ruefully*).

re *I* hope so, too.

PRINCESS.

lease look out.

I'll get my golden ball of joy—
ry to have a little fun with that.

ATTENDANT.

it for you.

COURTIER.

me, let me.

PRINCESS.

ere and rest. You'd need it I should think.

(She runs out. The others sink down with relief on the dais steps.)

ATTENDANT.

n the name of heaven, do you say
wful things?

COURTIER.

wful things, dear heart?

ATTENDANT.

ow, all that about her radiance?
rse it makes her simply furious.
ght that you were done for twice at least.

COURTIER.

a little nervous there myself.
they begin to talk that regal stuff
ever know where they, or you, will end.
at's the trouble with these kings and queens,
get a little mad, perhaps, and then
tick you in a dungeon, or perhaps
cut your head off—just like this—(*Makes motion of cutting off head.*)
all—
hims of Kings and things are passing strange! (*He makes a nonchalant gesture.*)

ATTENDANT.

ry, why do you say such silly things?

COURTIER.

tier's business is to flatter kings—
his excuse for being. Don't you know,
each the pages flattery in school.
t's a course—I passed it very high.

ATTENDANT.

nonsense!

COURTIER.

y dear—I'll tell you why
uch things. I mean them all for you.
nem to the Princess with my lips
se that's proper etiquette—but oh
art is singing them aloud to you. ^[6]

(*He tries to kiss her—the Princess enters but does not see them.*)

PRINCESS.

on now, here it is, let's have a game.

(*They throw the ball.*)

ATTENDANT.

Is we'd better all go out and play,
Might break something here, I think.

PRINCESS.

O—
It's too hot—my head aches—no, I won't.
It's much more fun to play in here.
More exciting, just because we might
 something over. My I'd like a crash—
A loud crashing smash.
Courtier) You throw too high,
 fair. *(He throws the ball off stage.)*
Now, see what you've done!

(All follow ball toward door. The Princess scrambles to catch it.)

ATTENDANT.

Where's it gone?

(The Princess disappears out of the door and calls back.)

PRINCESS *(outside)*.

Knocked out of my hands,
Dropped down in the courtyard,—hurry, do,
Rushing toward the fountain, stop it, quick. *(The Courtier rushes out, and the Princess comes back and throws herself down on the divan.)*
Isn't that a nuisance! What a day!
Everything's gone wrong, oh, what a bore!
It will probably stop up the drain,
Then papa will be so awfully cross.

ATTENDANT.

Is it would amuse you if I brought
A magic mirror of your beauty.

PRINCESS.

Of course I know I'm very beautiful,
what's the use of looking in the glass?

ATTENDANT.

Where that it would never bore me so.

PRINCESS (*with unintentional unkindness*).

It is not you. Oh well, then bring it on.
Can't we change our faces like our clothes.
I'm so tired of the same old face. (*Attendant hands her the mirror. The Princess gives a sudden scream.*)
Oh, oh, oh, do I look like that?

ATTENDANT.

What—like what?

PRINCESS.

Deer and lumpy—oh—
It can have happened—oh how horrible—
Where that I don't look like that—oh no!!

ATTENDANT (*frightened, looking first at Princess then at mirror*).

Don't, you don't—the mirror's just gone bad,
The glass is sort of curdled.

PRINCESS.

Oh.
Your milk, how dreadful, take it, quick!
I knew that glass could act like this—
It makes me feel quite seasick. Let's go out.

ATTENDANT.

It is you'd best lie down a little while

ke some wine, some of your father's—do—
l your mother—

PRINCESS (*grabbing her*).

—no, you won't.
tell Papa—I wouldn't have him know
ything. He'd be so awfully cross
hing has happened to that glass.
lways told me I must take such care
-and of my ball and of the globe.
e I haven't kept it clean enough—
ething. Hide it underneath the throne—(*She does so.*)
is a cool dark place will make it right.
on—let's go and help fish out the ball—
the Courtier must have fallen in
untain, he's been such a length of time.

(*Exit both. Enter King and Queen. Queen carries a chess board.*)

KING.

ow, my dear, she's almost seventeen,
othing's happened yet. I think she's safe.
row is her birthday. I'd forget
olish prophesy if I were you.

QUEEN (*sits down on chest*).

ou're a man. Of course you'd talk like that.

KING.

likely now that such a thing
happen, dear. I think it was a bluff
re us all—and it's so long ago—
re Aunt Fairy of the Sable Caves,
st forgotten all about the child.

QUEEN.

ll—of course, you men have just no nerves.
t feel safe until tomorrow's come.

KING.

f it were to happen, seems to me,
ld have happened long ago, my dear.

QUEEN.

his has been a simply ghastly year,
irdly dared to let her from my sight,
r that frightful spell would just swoop down.

KING.

ly has, my dear—and I'll be glad—
glad than I can say to have it end
row—there's no reason is there dear
ou're particularly worried now?
ything gone wrong?

QUEEN.

t at all.
: the child seems very cross to-day—
at's not natural at all you know.

KING.

ll, perhaps she feels us worrying.
agic charms are perfectly all right

QUEEN.

;-she had them all last night—quite safe.
ll and globe and mirror.

KING.

hen, come on, let's have a game of chess. (*They go up to divan, sit down, and begin to play.*)

our next door kingdom's much distressed
ravaged by a dragon that's appeared.

QUEEN.

ou don't say? Now isn't that a shame!
the nasty thing won't come to ours.

KING (*about the chess*).

most caught your queen now.

QUEEN (*listening*).

he comes.

(Enter Princess with Courtier and Attendant. The two latter bow formally to King and Queen, then stand at attention at either corner of the dais. The Princess sits down on the divan beside the King, rubs her face against his, and puts one arm around his neck. He squirms.)

KING.

et—where have you been? Excuse me, dear—
ow, I love your arm about my neck—
ally now—it's just a little damp.
an you have been doing with it, dear?

QUEEN (*worried*).

is it very wet? You may catch cold!

PRINCESS (*bored*).

I won't catch cold—it's nothing—please—
t's really hardly wet at all.

QUEEN.

id you get your arm wet? It's very odd.

PRINCESS.

ve've been dabbling in the fountain there,
my sleeve slipped in a bit—that's all.

KING.

obably was sailing little boats.

PRINCESS (*irritated*).

t a child, Papa. Tomorrow I'll
enteen, please do remember that.

QUEEN.

ere you playing in the fountain, dear?
ven't told us yet.

PRINCESS.

st because
hing of mine dropped in it. That was all.

KING.

d you get it out again, my dear?

PRINCESS.

t, no. I think the yellow frog
allowed it. It wasn't anything
ally important anyway. (*Courtier and Attendant exchange glances.*)
lease don't talk about it any more.
that something nice would happen. Oh
en a horrid day, just everything's
wrong, and I feel simply bored to death.

KING (*alarmed*).

et's do something then to cheer you up.

PRINCESS.

s not a thing to do—there never is.

QUEEN.

alk about your birthday presents then.

PRINCESS.

, that's such a bore. Tomorrow seems
ugh it were a hundred years away.

(The King and Queen start in consternation and horror and turn pale if possible.)

QUEEN *(gasping)*.

r't child; don't—

KING *(sternly)*.

why did you say that?

PRINCESS *(yawning)*.

lon't know I'm sure—why such a fuss?
(suddenly) Come on let's get my crystal globe and see
e is anything at all in that
amusing. Courtier—get it, please.

(He bows and goes out of the room.)

QUEEN.

you think it wise, to-day I mean.

PRINCESS.

re I can't see why it isn't wise,
k into my globe of wisdom now,
other time.

QUEEN (*reluctantly*).

is you wish.

(*Courtier enters with it, bows and places it on the dais in front of the Royal Group.*)

KING.

shall we look for dear? You'd better choose.

PRINCESS (*kneeling in front of King and Queen and looking in globe*).

what would be fun—let's look ahead
the future. Take tomorrow first.
tomorrow globe—now all look hard.

(*All are silent a minute gazing in globe.*)

PRINCESS.

tomorrow—quick you stupid thing—
fully queer and cloudy—sort of black—
saw it act that way before.

QUEEN (*nervously*).

ry do you suppose it's acting so?

KING (*with common sense*).

ply are not in the proper mood,
er reason.

PRINCESS.

isn't that.
ways clear, with pictures that are bright.
ture's stupid anyway. Let's look
ething in the past—my Christening—

QUEEN (*agonized*).

not that to-day, not that to-day.

PRINCESS (*as a spoiled child*).

dlesticks, why not. Ah here it is.
as, here's this same room—now this is clear—
re you are, Papa, and there's Mamma—
unnily you're dressed—the styles have changed
hen Mamma. Oh who are these—these three
lovely people?

QUEEN (*in a stifled voice*).

e the fairies, dear,
ave you your three lovely gifts you know.
hat's enough my dear—let's put it up.

PRINCESS.

, I won't. I want to see the rest.
who'se this coming in? A queer black thing,
awfully angry, and you look so scared.
re—the words she says are written out—
to the spell I lay”—



"LET'S LOOK AHEAD AND SEE THE FUTURE"

KING.

odkins! zounds!

(He raises his scepter and smashes the crystal globe. The Queen and Princess rise in horror and amazement.)

PRINCESS.

-papa—how could you—oh papa!
e broken it—my precious crystal globe.
ould you—and you’ve spoiled the picture, too!
it’s just too bad (*she sobs*).

KING (*dominating the scene*).

ild, no more—
ie king, no one may question me!
wer comes from heaven, that you know
ll as I. And if I choose to break
ystal globes of all my subjects—then
them I will and none may question why—
I choose, to go throughout the land
ch kitchen of each home therein,
ith my scepter, sweep from off the shelves,
ockery, and smash it on the floor—
ance upon the fragments, even then
e may question me, but must submit,
ith a gracious spirit, being glad
ave a king so wise and lenient.
ake this little lesson to thy heart.

PRINCESS (*quite humbly, kneeling*).

. I will—thy word, of course, is law—
would not presume to question thee.
thy pardon sire.
urtier and Attendant) Come along (*She jumps to her feet.*)
o up to the tower room and see
swallows’ eggs have hatched to-day.

(The King mops his brow. As Princess, Attendant and Courtier are about to go out, the Queen sees something sticking out from under the throne. She takes it out and sees the magic mirror, spoiled.)

QUEEN (*in horror*).

ar, your magic mirror—why, it’s spoiled!

PRINCESS (*pretending unconcern*).

, I found it out this afternoon
ter I had lost my ball of joy
in the fountain—Isn't it a shame.

(*She rushes out with Attendant and Courtier anxious to escape. The King and Queen look at each other in horror.*)

QUEEN (*in a whisper*).

iries' charms are ruined—

KING (*in despair*).

hat next?

Curtain.

ACT II. SCENE 2.

(The Attic near the tower room; a dim mysterious place; the fairy of the Sable Caves, disguised in a cap and apron, is spinning in one corner as the curtain rises.)

FAIRY OF THE SABLE CAVES (*chanting*).

wind, wind; the weary years roll by,
wind, wind; the time is drawing nigh,
wind, wind; the lagging moments creep.
wind, wind; the Princess soon shall sleep.

(She stops and listens a moment, and hears the Princess' voice outside.)

PRINCESS (*outside*).

t a single swallow's egg has hatched.
eel the wind blow on your face and see
ouds race by.

COURTIER (*outside*).

lown and see the knights.

PRINCESS (*outside*).

ook like tiny ants—we *are* high up.
let's go down. Oh what's that funny door?

COURTIER.

loor?

PRINCESS.

ttle one, hid in the wall,
ever seen it there in all my life.
ler where it leads to,—let's explore.

COURTIER.

, let's not, let's go down where it's warm.
robably leads in beneath the roofs—
e palace attics. Don't go in,
s nothing there but dark and dust and bats.

PRINCESS (*outside*).

—that sounds exciting—come along.

ATTENDANT (*outside*).

1't let's, Princess dear. It's awfully dark.

PRINCESS (*outside*).

dlesticks—come on.

FAIRY OF THE SABLE CAVES (*muttering to herself*).

on—come on.

(The Princess steps in slowly, and wonderingly, the others following. They do not at first notice the Fairy of the Sable Caves who pays no attention to them but goes on spinning and winding her distaff in the corner.)

PRINCESS (*almost whispering*).

1at a queer old place!

ATTENDANT.

—there's a bat!

FAIRY OF THE SABLE CAVES (*chanting*).

wind, wind, the weary years roll by.

PRINCESS.

—shhh—what's that? Some one is singing—Hush.

ATTENDANT.

let's go down—

PRINCESS.

's see who it is. (*She steals up nearer to the Fairy of the Sable Caves.*)
day, old mother, may I watch thy work?

FAIRY OF THE SABLE CAVES (*not paying any attention*).

wind, wind; the time is drawing nigh. (*then suddenly starting and looking at her.*)
what you say? I'm getting deaf, my dear?

PRINCESS.

l if I might watch you at your work?
cinating. I have never seen
work before.

FAIRY OF THE SABLE CAVES.

s that you say? I'm deaf.
nearer, please.

PRINCESS (*shouting*).

work; I like your work!

FAIRY OF THE SABLE CAVES (*as though she misunderstood*).

, there isn't any bats up here.

PRINCESS (*shouting*).

ts, not bats—your work—I like your work.
tell me how you do it—it's so strange.

FAIRY OF THE SABLE CAVES (*agreeably*).

irst you take it in your hand like this.

COURTIER (*to Attendant*).

is that?

ATTENDANT.

Why; why?

COURTIER.

Heavens, no!!

His command—Don't touch it Princess, don't.

FAIRY.

Hold it in your hand like this and wind.

COURTIER (*pulling Princess away*).

Don't touch it!

PRINCESS (*enraged*).

How dare you!

COURTIER.

Princess, don't, upon your life, your father—

PRINCESS (*imitating her father's manner*).

Yes, sir—

Oh Princess, would you question me?

Whether I came from heaven, and I touch

Whatever I may please; no matter what (*Changes suddenly to the manner of a child.*)

As she says. So there!

COURTIER.

Do not touch this.

PRINCESS.

Send me unto the executioner at once.

nsolence!!

COURTIER.

ers not, I care not if I die,
u shall not!

(He starts forward to prevent her taking the distaff.)

FAIRY *(to Courtier)*.

back, or I will turn you into stone—
rm is stone; you cannot move or speak. *(Courtier stands motionless with arm
upraised.)*
incess.) Now take it in your hand and wind, and wind,
wind, wind, the lagging moments creep—

PRINCESS.

'un, what jolly fun, this little thing
e quite new. I'd like to show mamma!

FAIRY.

e it down and show mamma,
ve your parents a surprise; a *nice* surprise.

PRINCESS.

nks a thousand times. *(looking at Courtier)* Please let him come.
he's sorry now.

FAIRY.

ie down soon,
my dear, go down.

PRINCESS.

nk you, thanks. *(Exit, pulling the reluctant Attendant.)*

FAIRY.

wind, wind, the Princess soon shall sleep.

Curtain.

ACT II. SCENE 3. Same as Scene 1.

(The King is walking nervously up and down the room. The Queen is sitting on the bench, sewing on an embroidery frame.)

KING *(pulling his moustache)*.

to goodness she'd come back. Dear me,
ever known as long a day as this.

QUEEN.

ry to think of something else. Let's talk
nothing pleasant. Do you think, my dear,
ragon in the kingdom next to ours
ross the border into this?

KING.

.
ew thorn hedge I've just had planted there
eep all dragons out—it's dragon proof.

QUEEN *(gets up and walks to King)*.

fully low.

KING.

it it's awfully sharp.

QUEEN.

, it's growing dusk!

KING.

so it is,
y is almost over.

QUEEN.

ie's safe—
most safe, I think.

(The Princess dashes in behind the King. The Attendant follows.)

PRINCESS *(in the King's ear)*.

KING *(jumping and turning around)*.

y child,
odkins how you frightened me. Dear me
art is going pit-a-pat with fear.

PRINCESS.

I old timid thing to be a king.
amma, what do you think I've found!

QUEEN *(interested and relieved now that the Princess has returned
in such good spirits)*.

imagine dear—what have you found?

PRINCESS.

It is here behind my back. Just guess.
Nothing awfully interesting and strange.
Guess papa—just guess what it can be.

KING *(indulgently)*.

Now—let's see—a phoenix egg, perhaps,
found in the tower.

PRINCESS.

Amma you guess.

QUEEN.

A white kitten with a golden tongue.

PRINCESS.

o—what foolish guesses! Now papa.

KING.

ng gold finch—or a magic purse.

PRINCESS.

, it's none of these; now watch me, see—*(She jumps up to the throne, stands before them and displays the distaff proudly.)*
ite the strangest thing I've ever seen.

(All stand petrified with horror—a deep sigh escapes from the King and Queen.)

KING-QUEEN.

iff!

QUEEN.

child; my little girl!

PRINCESS (*gaily*).

o you look so scared? It works like this. *(The King makes a sudden leap to snatch it from her hand. As he does so, it scratches her.)*
don't, Papa—ouch, ouch, I've scratched my hand.

QUEEN.

—oh no!

KING (*as if frozen*).

s my dear—she has.
ind it quickly. No this is the spell!
he spell.

PRINCESS.

gracious what a fuss.
t a little tiny scratch; that's all—
other so? (*She sits down on divan.*)
ne, I seem to be (*She yawns.*)
wfully sleepy, and mamma you look
to drop right off (*she stretches out*).
I'll take
nap. Sweet dreams (*she dozes off*).

KING (*kissing her and arranging her dress comfortably*).
dreams, my dear—

(*He yawns—the Queen and Attendants yawn.*)

QUEEN (*nodding*).
feel sleepy, too—I think that I—

(*She drops off to sleep.*)

KING (*yawning*).
ant, go prepare the Princess' bed.
perhaps she'll sleep for rather long (*shivers*).

(*Courtier is heard calling from outside, then he dashes in.*)

COURTIER.
away from her my lord—She has
iff—Oh, I tried—A frightful spell
ne—oh—oh, I'm not too late,—I'm not
e—I tried,—I tried,—but failed.—

(*He sinks down upon the floor, asleep, with his head in the lap of the
Princess' Attendant.*)

Curtain.

ACT III. SCENE 1.

(Outside the thorn hedge that separates the palace of the Sleeping Beauty from the world. A horn is heard off stage. Presently the Prince enters with horn and spear. He stands in front of the hedge and blows again, then calls.)

PRINCE.

—haloo.

ANSWER *(faintly)*.

PRINCE.

on this way,
und a little clearing—come along.

(Crackling outside and Gentleman in Waiting appears.)

GENTLEMAN.

s, but I'm all scratched up—these beastly thorns
st like lion's claws. Where are we now?

PRINCE *(shrugging his shoulders)*.

1't ask me—I'm perfectly at sea—

GENTLEMAN.

is to me we're more like in the woods.

PRINCE *(laughing)*.

a—you're right—come on old boy, cheer up.

GENTLEMAN *(grumpily)*.

1—what's the use, we're lost—we've got to starve.
followed this old claw thorn hedge all day,
rest is as thick as banks of spears,
—it is—our falcon's blown away—
In't get the stag we chased—gadzooks
n's like ribbons on a maying pole.

PRINCE.

ll, cheer up, at least we're still alive.

GENTLEMAN.

just the trouble. If I weren't alive
dn't know how beastly starved I am.

PRINCE (*sitting down comfortably with his back to the hedge*).

; we'll last a little longer.

GENTLEMAN.

1!

PRINCE (*feeling in his pouch*).

here, look here, I've got a bit of bread,
ght it out to feed the falcon with.
ake it if you're hungry. (*He tosses it to Gentleman.*)

GENTLEMAN (*glumly*).

e, no—

PRINCE (*breaking it and taking much the smaller piece*).

share it then. (*He feels again in his pouch.*)
here's a piece of cheese!

GENTLEMAN (*starting to put it in his mouth*).

—good.

PRINCE.

, it's just a candle's end.

GENTLEMAN.

was just about to eat it—bah!

PRINCE.

ave it—we may have to eat it yet.

GENTLEMAN.

ead is awfully dry—I wish I had
l meat pastry now—

PRINCE.

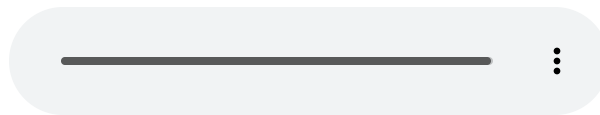
rown old ale!
ing lustily.) Oh give me the good meat pies of old;
e me the foaming ale,
e flaming logs when the day grows cold
dusk the minstrel's tale—
e me a sword with a straight blue blade,
e tourney's clash and din—
merrie heart and unafraid,
princess fair to win!
e—



THE PRINCE'S SONG.

F. FANCHER—

Maestoso—



GENTLEMAN (*nervously*).

'd, pray do you think it wise—
 3—well, quite so loudly?

PRINCE.

Why not?
 I'll disturb the birds—or do you think
 they'll be jealous? (*Stands up, takes off his hat and bows.*) Birds, I humbly
 crave thy pardons.

GENTLEMAN (*rising*).

My Lord—I only thought
 since we don't know what is hidden there—
 I might perhaps—

PRINCE.

I'll admit my voice

artle even dragons into rage.

GENTLEMAN (*in fear*).

, don't say you think there's dragons there.

(*Pointing behind hedge.*)

PRINCE.

dn't be surprised—big scaly ones.

GENTLEMAN (*putting an eye fearsomely to hedge*).

see any; oh let's go away.
dn't want to meet a dragon—sire.

PRINCE.

safe enough I think—the hedge seems high
arp enough to keep all dragons out. (*then seeing that the Gentleman is truly
terrified.*)
was only fooling you, old boy.
ly dragons live in minstrels' tales—
s not one left alive these days. But still
s *something* queer about these woods.

GENTLEMAN.

.
eer for me!

PRINCE.

ll day long I've thought
se old minstrels' tales I used to love
I was just a little lad, and sat
the great log fire, listening,
lled and frightened that I hardly breathed.

GENTLEMAN.

ys went to sleep when minstrels came (*sitting down*).

PRINCE.

ere was one tale that they used to tell
this very forest, so they say,
ere was once a castle here, and all
ople in it were asleep: the King
ueen, and even all the mice and rats
leeping. And there was a Princess, too,
utiful she made your heart stand still.
to dream about her on those nights,
ake and look across our battlements,
ow I'd marry her when I grew up.
ose were minstrels' tales—(*He sighs*)
on, wake up—(*He shakes Gentleman's shoulder.*)
r I'll find a way inside the hedge.

GENTLEMAN.

1't—oh don't, I'm sure it isn't safe.

PRINCE (*nobly*).

afety when we're old, but while we're young
seek adventure with courageous hearts!

GENTLEMAN (*sighing*).

ht my lord, you're right—As usual.
ll I think that we were fools to come
int here in these woods when everyone
was dangerous.

PRINCE.

omen's talk! (*He searches up and down hedge.*)
ler what's behind it. Oh look here!
n opening I think—yes—yes—(*He crawls half through hedge, his feet
sticking back.*)
y—I can make it bigger though.

GENTLEMAN.

fooling me again.

PRINCE.

t I swear—(*He works at making hole bigger.*)

GENTLEMAN.

believe you—for you never lie.

PRINCE.

—I'm through. Well, by my halidome!

GENTLEMAN.

lo you see?

PRINCE.

y my halidome!

GENTLEMAN (*terrified*).

s it? Are you hurt my lord?
out (*he tries to pull the Prince back by his legs*).

PRINCE.

heavens, no—let go you idiot
pull my legs off—hi—let go I say.

(*Gentleman lets go—the Prince disappears and speaks from outside.*)

GENTLEMAN.

on's got you! Oh, my lord—my lord.

PRINCE.

, there's not a sign of one—but oh

through, come quick, oh, oh, how wonderful:
ce, gray and old, and everything
own around it, thick rank vines and trees—
umbling turrets, and a drawbridge, too,
nbling in, and there's a green old moat.
let's explore the castle, hurry through.

(The Gentleman in Waiting fearsomely scrambles through.)

Curtain.

ACT III. SCENE 2.

Same as Act II. Scene 3.

(The tableau is the same, except that great cobwebs are about. The King, Queen, Princess, and attendants are all sleeping quietly. It is growing dusk. A thin thread of light comes in the door. The Prince enters, carrying his candle. He comes slowly and quietly and looks about in wonder. At first he does not see the Princess who is in deep shadow. The Gentleman in Waiting follows him in fear.)

PRINCE.

—hush, go softly—

GENTLEMAN.

Are they dead, my lord?

PRINCE.

Yes, I think. They're breathing easily. *(Flashes his light on Man at Arms in doorway.)*

There, a spider's web about his spear.

GENTLEMAN *(in scorn)*.

A soldier that! bound by a spider's web.

PRINCE.

—the whole whole palace is asleep.

GENTLEMAN.

What of is crumbling in up there, my lord.

PRINCE.

There, a vine has grown between the stones.
(silently.) The dust is inches thick upon the floor—

asily they breathe! How strange—how strange.
his real—or am I in a dream?
epped into some minstrel's tale myself.
l this glamour of enchantment deep,
ystery, and silence, and the ache
nder in my heart,—and I myself—
just brilliant, colored words and thoughts,
or a moment on a winter's night,
nd forgotten e're the fire dies.

GENTLEMAN (*touching him*).

ere's a fly asleep upon the wall.

PRINCE (*jumping*).

are no flies in dreams, so this is real—

GENTLEMAN.

l enough, my lord—come on, let's go.
ine feels just like icicles—come on.

PRINCE.

ve slept a long, long time, I think. Those clothes
e the ones they wore long, long ago—
ler if they've dreamed and what they've dreamed.
ey've slept long enough.
lls) Wake up—wake up!

(*Silence.*)

GENTLEMAN.

ne, come home, this is a dreadful place.

PRINCE (*calling again*).

re—haloo—wake up (*he shakes the Courtier*).

GENTLEMAN.

He in a spell—
The place is haunted—come away my lord.

PRINCE.

Now this adventure to the end—

GENTLEMAN.

Not like those rows of men at arms
Sleeping in their armor in the halls,
Nor the sleeping servants that we passed—
Dangerous I tell you—come away—

PRINCE.

Not yet, the old tales said there was
Acess.

GENTLEMAN (*looking at King*).

There's someone in a crown.

PRINCE.

There's the king, the princess must be near.

GENTLEMAN (*disgusted*).

Now'n's all crooked.

PRINCE (*rebuking him*).

He is a king (*he bows to the sleeping King as he passes him*).

(The Gentleman in Waiting stops before the Princess' Attendant in admiration. The Prince steps up on the dais, and holds his candle so that the light, but not the grease, falls upon her face. He stands silent a moment, gasps in wonder, then takes off his plumed hat reverently.)

Androus one, the olden tales were true—

beauty, oh, thy beauty floods my soul
olden visions of eternal joy.
let me kneel and worship at thy shrine.

(He kneels and kisses her—a long kiss. She slowly opens her eyes and gazes at him. The others begin to awaken slowly.)

PRINCESS *(smiling at him dreamily)*.
gain.

PRINCE *(kissing her hand)*.
d.

PRINCESS.
re you?

PRINCE.
ly prince.

PRINCESS *(half sitting up)*.
nce, my very own?
lorious! I've dreamed that you would come—

PRINCE.
of you beloved—

PRINCESS.
y dreams
't half as wonderful as you—not half!

(Gradually the people awaken. The Queen sneezes loudly and suddenly, and all but the Prince and Princess rise.)

QUEEN.
w—kechew—what simply frightful dust!

ere's a cobweb in your crown—get out!
isty thing (*brushes off King's crown*).

KING (*stretching*).

I've had a nap. How dark it is!
he casement, Courtier. (*The light grows brighter as Courtier obeys.*) I
declare!

QUEEN.

re those strange young men I'd like to know!

(*The Prince's Gentleman has been trying to kiss the Princess' Attendant.*)

ATTENDANT.

ute! He tried to kiss me!

COURTIER (*to Gentleman*).

get out! (*A scuffle ensues.*)

KING.

stop this most disgraceful row at once.
ince) And who in thunder, sir, are you? And what,
have you done?!!!

PRINCE.

ssed your daughter, sire (*All are horrified*).

KING.

ou admit it to my face! What, ho
ards! You will repent this insult gross
ure in my deepest dungeon dark!

PRINCE.

h me as you will, I'll gladly spend
e in any dungeon that you choose,

for that one kiss. The price is small.

QUEEN.

ely very rude; I'm quite surprised.

KING.

rude!! Well, I should say! Perhaps you think
se I just dropped off for forty winks,
m so old and lazy that I can't
t my daughter from such men as you.

PRINCESS.

papa, oh please don't be so cross.

KING.

tell me how you two got through the hall.
were my men all doing to allow
ers here? That's what I'd like to know.

PRINCE.

were all sleeping, sir, as we came past.

QUEEN.

hey all sleeping, too? How very odd!
we must have eaten something queer
ich that made us all drop off to sleep.
is it was those canned pomegranate seeds.

KING.

nonsense—to the dungeon, sir, you go.

PRINCESS.

go too. I like him very much. (*She takes his hand proudly and steps toward the front of the dais. As she does so she kicks the distaff and it rolls into view.*)

QUEEN.

re's that horrid distaff—throw it out.
afraid you'll prick your finger, dear.

PRINCESS.

so I did before I went to sleep—

KING.

we went to sleep—How long—how long, have we been sleeping?

PRINCE.

undred years or so, I think.

ALL.

t be true!

KING.

ell has passed, and we're awake again!
sir, pray pardon me. I did not know,
I not guess—it *seemed* just like a nap.

PRINCESS.

s he's always cross when first he wakes,
ually he is a perfect dear.

PRINCE (*bowing*).

perfect father anyway,
d have done as he did had you been
ughter, oh beloved. But I'm glad
not.

KING.

sir, we owe our life to you.

That my rage has passed I see you are
of noble birth—undoubtedly a prince.

Give me what you will, and it is yours.
You have freed us from this dreadful spell,
and wakened us from our hundred years of sleep.

PRINCE (*kneeling*).

For I am unworthy, but I crave
your daughter's hand in marriage.

PRINCESS (*kneeling*).

Oh, please—
do not like him!

QUEEN (*softly*).

He seems to be
a very fine young man.

KING.

There he is.
Now, I give my daughter unto you,
and half my kingdom shall be yours as well—[\[7\]](#)

QUEEN.

Lead him down into the banquet hall!!

PRINCE.

Once
I was laid to rest in dust of a hundred years away.

(All exit joyously. The Prince and Princess lead. The King and Queen follow. Then come the Courtier and the Princess's Attendant, and the others.)

Curtain.

FOOTNOTES:

[1] (See [note 1](#) at end of play.)

[2] (See [note 2](#) at end of play.)

[3] (See [note 3](#) at end of play.)

[4] (See [note 4](#) at end of play.)

[5] (See [note 5](#). at end of play.)

[6] (See [note 6](#). at end of play.)

[7] (See [note 7](#).)

THE ADDITION OF PAGEANTRY.

Note 1. The Sleeping Beauty is a story especially suitable for Spring presentation, since for many centuries and by many races its meaning has been symbolic of the reawakening of nature. Winter, personified by the Wicked Fairy, lays a spell upon Nature, causing her to fall into a deep sleep. This may be dispelled only by the kiss of Spring, the Prince of the fairy tale.

Note 2. The play as it stands may easily be expanded into a pageant by the addition of more characters, and the interpolation of dances.

The extra characters may be:

Fairies attending the Fairy of the Golden Isles, the Fairy of the Crystal Mountains, and the Fairy of the Silver Rivers.

Evil Imps and Goblins to come at the summons of the Fairy of the Sable Caves.

Pages, Minstrels, Ladies and Gentlemen in Waiting, Men at Arms, Castle Attendants, Cooks, etc.

Note 3. If the play is presented as a pageant with many additional characters, it is suggested that the action take place in the Best, instead of the Second Best Throne Room of the King and Queen. The Second Best Throne Room was rather small and therefore more appropriate for the few characters of the original cast.

Note 4. The first dance may take place in the First Act, when the three Fairies present their gifts to the baby Princess. As many fairies as are desired may be used for this dance. See note 10 for all music.

Note 5. The second dance may be a dance of Imps and Goblins, also in the First Act. They enter with a screaming rush at the words of the Fairy of the Sable Caves:

‘Demons and Trolls who dwell in dungeon moats,
Come near, come near—’

Then they join in a wild sinister dance. The Fairy of the Sable Caves stops speaking until they finish the dance, then she continues with:

“Come weave a spell with me!”

They make their exit as she leaves the stage.

Note 6. The third dance may be in the Second Act when the Princess brings in the Golden Ball. Ladies and Gentlemen in Waiting follow her as she enters. They toss the ball back and forth slowly to music. The extra dancers make their exit after the words, “It’s rolling toward the fountain, stop it, quick!”

Note 7. The last dance takes place at the end of the play. Its participants are the additional Pages, Minstrels, Jesters, Ladies and Gentlemen in Waiting, Men at Arms, Castle Attendants, Cooks, etc.

If this dance is desired it will be necessary to insert a few lines after the King’s speech ending:

‘Rise Son, I give my daughter unto you,
And half my kingdom shall be yours as well.”

INSERT.

QUEEN.

I the people of the palace here,
They may all rejoice in this glad day.

COURTIER (*Goes to the door and calls*).

Ho! Attendants of the palace all
Presence is desired by the Queen!

KING (*as they enter*).

There be revelry and mirth and joy.
The spell is broken, and here stands
The future king!

QUEEN.

minstrels, strike the lute
t the clarion play.

PRINCESS (*clapping her hands joyfully*).

ance!

PRINCE.

ince
ad dust of a hundred years away.

Note 8. If the play is too long with the suggested additions it is possible to omit Scene 2, Act II., and Scene 1, Act III.

PROPERTIES.

Note 9. The most important properties are tapestries, the cradle, crowns, headdresses, parchments, the Fairies' gifts, swords, spears, scepter—armor, if there are men at arms, the spinning wheel and distaff.

The tapestries may be made by painting with house paints upon burlap. Crowns, headdresses and armor may be made out of heavy buckram painted with silver paint; the parchments, of strips of ordinary brown wrapping paper, painted with white house paint, then roughly illuminated with lines of gold paint, touches of green and red water colors added, and then hand printed in heavy ink. The white paint must be put on thinly, with a rotary movement of the brush.... The Crystal Globe of Wisdom may be a crystal colored Christmas tree ornament.

For the last scene in the last act, an excellent effect is gained by fastening great cobwebs of woven string across the front of the stage, and by putting smaller ones over the sleeping figures. There is a spider web pattern used in linen hand drawn work, which may be made many times larger.

Note 10. Music for the Sleeping Beauty.

ACT I.

(1) Fairy Dance around the Cradle.

Minuet in G, Beethoven.

(Victor Record 17,934-B. Natalie and Victor Bashko.)

(2) Dance of Evil Imps.

Marche Slave, Tschaikowsky.

(Victor Record 70050. Victor Herbert's Orchestra.)

Play first part only, slow movement—stopping before portion is reached where old National Anthem is used.

(3) Music while the Fairy of the Silver River changes the spell.

Minuet in G—first part played softly.

(4) Exit—

Chanson Louis XIII and Pavane—Couperin-Kreisler.

(Victor Record 64,292. Fritz Kreisler.)

ACT II.

(1) Game with Golden Ball.

Paderewski's "Minuet."

(2) End—where Princess and Court go to sleep.

Minuet in G played softly.

ACT III.

Dance of Court.

Minuet—Boccherini ("Celebrated Minuet.")

(Victor Record 64,614. Fritz Kreisler.)

Transcriber's Notes

Obvious typographical errors and punctuation errors have been silently corrected after careful comparison with other occurrences within the text and consultation of external sources. Some hyphens in words have been silently removed and some silently added when a predominant preference was found in the original book. Some stage directions have been reformatted to improve consistency.

Except for those changes noted below, all misspellings and inconsistent spellings have been retained.

[Page 16](#): replaced "turning his moustach" with "turning his moustache".

[Page 25](#): replaced "it musn't spoil" with "it mustn't spoil".

[Page 26](#): replaced "ACT II." with "ACT II. SCENE 1.".

[Second illustration](#): replaced "LETS LOOK AHEAD" with "LET'S LOOK AHEAD".

[Page 48](#): replaced "the Princess's Attendant" with "the Princess' Attendant".

[Page 50](#): replaced "if your hungry" with "if you're hungry".

[Page 50](#): replaced "it to attendant" with "it to Gentleman".

[Page 52](#): replaced two instances of "ATTENDANT" with "GENTLEMAN".

[Page 56](#): replaced "flys in dreams" with "flies in dreams".

[Page 65–66](#): replaced all variants of "Minuett" or "Minuette" with "Minuet".

The music file ("[The Prince's Song](#)") is the music transcriber's interpretation of the printed notation and is in the public domain.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE SLEEPING
BEAUTY ***

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